



PAST DUE

A Mystery-Drama Set in the Heart of Atlanta

Format: Original Movie of the Week (MOW)

Genre: Mystery / Drama / Psychological Suspense

Tone: Atmospheric, intimate, and emotionally gripping

Setting: Atlanta – Historic West End, Old Fourth Ward, courthouse, and real estate spaces

LOGLINE

When a rising real estate attorney inherits her aunt's dilapidated West End home, she discovers a long-lost family secret buried beneath the floorboards, one connected to a decades old missing persons case and a life she never knew was hers.

THE HOOK

What if your family's biggest secret was... you?

PAST DUE combines legal drama, generational mystery, and emotional suspense in a grounded thriller about identity, inheritance, and uncovering truth, whether you're ready for it or not.

It's Losing Isaiah meets A Fall From Grace with the moody investigation energy of The Vanishing Half.

CONCEPT OVERVIEW

Tiana Grant, 35, is a sharp, respected real estate attorney with a high-rise view, a corporate wardrobe, and no time for nostalgia. She left Atlanta's West End years ago and doesn't plan to look back.

But when her estranged Aunt Noreen dies, Tiana inherits a run-down Victorian house near Spelman that her aunt refused to sell, no matter how many investors came knocking. Tiana

sees it as a liability, until she finds strange letters, hidden photographs, and whispered warnings from an elderly neighbor who claims *"that house doesn't belong to you, not really."*

Tiana digs. And finds out about **Devon Carter**, a teenage girl who went missing in 1995, last seen just a block from the home. A girl no one ever looked for. A girl who looked a lot like Tiana.

What begins as a home renovation project becomes an unraveling of everything Tiana thought she knew. Why did her aunt cut off her mother? Why was Devon never found? And what if Tiana wasn't adopted by choice but by force?

CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

TIANA GRANT (35)

Smart, confident, emotionally reserved. She's built her career on logic, success, and distance from her roots. But the deeper she digs, the more vulnerable and human, she becomes.

Arc: From closed-off and disconnected to deeply rooted and emotionally awakened.

AUNT NOREEN (Deceased – 60s)

Seen through flashbacks, journals, and community memory. A fiercely protective, secretive woman who did what she had to do to protect a child and never forgave herself.

DEVON CARTER (15, in flashbacks)

Missing since 1995. Sweet, musically talented, and quiet. Her story haunts the film, piece by piece, until it's clear: she didn't vanish. She was taken.

GLORIA GRANT (Tiana's mother, 50s)

Tense, well-mannered, deeply religious. Determined to maintain a version of the past that serves her narrative, even if it means lying to her daughter.

MRS. FRANKLIN (70s)

Next-door neighbor. Churchgoing gossip and low-key truth-teller. She knows a lot and says just enough to keep Tiana digging.

ACT STRUCTURE (4 ACT FORMAT)

ACT 1:

Tiana inherits the house. Begins cleaning it out. Finds letters, old photos, and meets Mrs. Franklin. First mention of Devon Carter.

ACT 2:

Flashbacks begin. Tiana searches old news archives. Her mother warns her to let it go. Community members grow wary. She finds a hidden basement compartment with Devon's backpack inside.

ACT 3:

Tiana confronts her mother and uncovers the truth: she is Devon Carter. Her aunt took her after a violent domestic altercation with her biological father. Records were falsified.

ACT 4:

Tiana decides to honor Devon's memory by renovating the home into a community safe haven for girls. In doing so, she claims both her past and her future.

VISUAL STYLE & TONE

- Warm, earthy tones in flashbacks
- Cold, minimal blues and grays in Tiana's modern life
- Moored-camera intimacy inside the house

- Visual metaphors: peeling wallpaper, a locked basement door, old Polaroids

Think:

- *The Vanishing Half* (aesthetic and tone)
- *The Clark Sisters* (emotional realism)
- *Secrets of the Summer House* (mystery pacing)

Soundtrack: Soulful, reflective score with Atlanta R&B undertones and instrumental strings. Gospel elements during emotional climax.

WHY THIS MOVIE WINS

Emotional character arc meets slow-burn mystery

Black female-led story that celebrates truth, legacy, and healing

A rare blend of legal drama, family tension, and identity thriller

Socially relevant themes: generational trauma, adoption secrecy, domestic abuse survival

Atlanta's cultural and visual texture provides a grounded, marketable backdrop

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Women 25–54
 - Fans of *Lust*, *Line Sisters*, *Greenleaf*, and *A Fall From Grace*
 - Viewers seeking high-emotion, layered storytelling with satisfying twists
 - Ideal for Lifetime, BET+, OWN, VH1 Movies, or Hallmark Mahogany (if softened for tone)
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DELIVERY & PRODUCTION READY

- **Runtime:** 85–90 minutes
 - **Location:** Atlanta (West End, interior and exterior home, 3–4 primary locations)
 - **Budget:** Moderate
 - **Cast:** 1 lead, 3 strong supporting women, 1-2 men, small ensemble flashbacks
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CREATED BY: Kelly R. Tenney